Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Dol Y Felin

Dolyfelin Homes, Pentre Road St. Clears, Carmarthen, SA33 4LR

01994 230039

The inspection visits for this service took place between 27/07/2026 and 03/08/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Carmarthenshire County Council Adults and Children's Services
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care
Registered places:	33
Main language(s):	Welsh and English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider promotes, anticipates, identifies, and meets the Welsh language and culture needs of people.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

People who have made Dol y Felin their home receive a good standard of care. Everyone we spoke with has high levels of confidence in the service.

People experience good wellbeing because of the relationships they have with the people important to them and the staff team. This, together with the range of opportunities to do things that matter to them mean their days are generally meaningful and they are treated with dignity and respect.

Care and support is rated as good because the team is led by an experienced and dedicated manager who is supported by a deputy and team of staff who share the values of the service and strive to provide individualised and person-centred care and support. Detailed personal plans help to inform and direct care and the planned improvements will enhance this further.

The environment is rated as good because standards of cleanliness are high and whilst some areas would benefit from updating it is mostly as homely and comfortable as possible.

Leadership and management is rated as good because the values set by the manager are embedded into practice. The manager is very visible throughout the service and has a good knowledge of the people cared for, their families and the staff team. Some improvements to the internal auditing processes would enhance this further.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

The relationships people have with those caring for them is a special feature of this service. Relatives have very high levels of confidence in the staff team. One told us, "*Staff are very very good… X is getting better care than I could give her"* and another said, "*The staff are very friendly."* People living at the service are just as positive with one telling us, "*The staff are marvellous"* and another described the staff as "*Very friendly."*

There are opportunities for people to do things that matter to them and they enjoy. This includes helping out in the garden and greenhouse as well as activities inside the service, including crafts, baking and quizzes. Residents of the local area come in to spend time with people including singers and musicians. There are photograph albums which capture how people engage with these activities. Most people think there is enough going on within the service but some people told us they would like to see more activities and opportunities for engagement taking place.

There are opportunities for people to speak in Welsh if they choose. Personal plans contain information about the people's language of choice and there are some Welsh speaking staff and others who are either learning or have some basic knowledge. Some people we spoke with appreciated the ability to speak in Welsh. Some information and signage is available bilingual

People are safe and protected from abuse and neglect. This is because there are good security measures to prevent unauthorised access to the home and its grounds; staff know their responsibilities in relation to safeguarding and they have completed training in safeguarding. People are treated with dignity and respect because workers understand they are working in the people's home and the trust and responsibility placed on them. The recruitment processes are robust and safe meaning people appointed have the right skills, knowledge and aptitude for the job. Visitors are welcomed to the service and have a good rapport with the staff team.

The environment contributes, to some degree to people's well-being. Whilst parts of the service would benefit from some redecoration and updating, people describe the service as "*Spotless."* The staff team have tried to make the service as homely as possible and are considering ways to enhance this further.

Care & Support — Good

People receive the care and support they need. The staff team are motivated, friendly and caring. Care records are comprehensive and care workers find them helpful. Each person has an informative personal profile which sets out what and who is important to them. Also other helpful information including how people like to spend their time, what help they need and any communication needs. Daily entries are informative and mostly person centred. Personal plans are reviewed regularly and there is clear evidence people or their representatives have contributed to their plans. We saw the efforts made by the staff team to celebrate people's special events and a relative told us "*I can honestly say the staff always go above and beyond. X loves it here. She is treated like a Queen.".*

There is an understanding of the importance of good nutrition. Most meals are made using fresh ingredients, with little reliance on processed food. The catering team are satisfied with the quality of ingredients they have and cupboards, fridges and freezers are well stocked. The catering team take pride in their work and are responsible for serving people their meals meaning they have a good knowledge of people's likes dislikes and any special requirements. Special events are celebrated and special diets catered for. The efforts made by the catering team are appreciated by the rest of the team, people and their relatives. One person described the food they are served as "*Marvellous."*

Food is available outside of mealtimes and specialist advice is sought from both the dieticians and speech & language therapists as necessary and their advice is followed by the team.

Physical health needs are met with people having dental and opticians' appointments. The manager told us they have a very good relationship with the local GP practice which is responsive to any requests. A visiting health professional was very complimentary about the service, describing it as "*Very welcoming, very friendly."* Interventions they ask to be done are carried out by care workers as requested. Some people have been assessed as being at risk of developing pressure damage and are, therefore assisted to be repositioned on a regular basis. Care workers are confident this is done but there are some gaps in the records. The manager agreed to discuss this with the care workers to make sure the records are a full and accurate record of people's care.

People are safe and protected from harm and abuse. Visitors are required to sign into a visitor's book meaning staff know who is in the service at all times. All staff spoken with know their responsibilities to report any safeguarding concerns and there is an up-to-date safeguarding policy for staff to refer to as well as regular safeguarding training. Referrals are made to the adult protection team as needed. Whilst care workers have had no reason to raise any safeguarding concerns, they are confident they know how to and are also confident the manager would deal with any concerns correctly.

People's medication is safely managed. A check of controlled drugs showed there are the correct number of tablets available and accurate records are maintained. Some care workers have been trained in the safe administration of medicines and there is always at least one member of staff on

duty who has completed this training and been assessed as competent. This means people can have medication at the times they need it. If medication is omitted, the reasons for this is not always recorded and the regular medication audits have not picked this up. The manager has agreed to review this to make sure there is a clear record to indicate why medication has not been given.

Environment

Good

People live in an environment that meets their needs. There is a programme of ongoing refurbishment and redecoration and whilst some areas are tired and dated, it is reasonably homely and comfortable. People we spoke with and their relatives, are wholly satisfied with the environment they live in.

Bedrooms are personalised with items of furniture, photographs, ornaments and soft furnishings. None of the bedrooms have ensuite facilities but there are adequate numbers of bathrooms and toilets, some of which have been updated.

Signs on bedrooms doors help with orientation and also contain some helpful information about the individual including what and who is important to them.

There are communal lounges and a dining room for people to spend time with others. An additional smaller lounge is a place where people can spend quieter time or meet with relatives.

Improvements have been made to the outside areas with further developments planned. A new greenhouse is being used to grow vegetables and raised beds are planted up with colourful flowers. The gardens are generally well maintained and accessible for people.

The kitchen has been awarded the maximum score of five by the Food Standards Agency. This means the facilities in the kitchen were considered to be very good. Catering staff say they have the equipment they need and everything is in good working order.

There are some effective processes in place to make sure equipment and services are maintained and in good working order, including fire safety equipment, moving and handling equipment, beds and water temperatures.

Leadership & Management — Good

There are some effective and robust governance arrangements in place to monitor quality. The Responsible Individual has good oversight of the service and visits regularly. The manager has regular contact with them. The reports written are comprehensive and focus on quality and service improvements. A range of audits are completed to further monitor quality but some greater rigor would enhance the value of these further.

Staff are appointed following a safe recruitment process. Files contain the required information including references and security checks. All staff have a period of induction before working independently. There is some use of agency workers but these are staff who know the service and work there regularly. There is a strong focus on training and records show training compliance is largely up to date with some training planned. Care workers find the training helpful and they are able to request additional training. Care workers are appropriately supervised and records show supervision is largely up to date. Care workers consider they get balanced feedback on their work to help them in their ongoing professional development.

The staff team work well together and respect and value everyone who works at the service. This includes the housekeeping, catering, maintenance staff and volunteers who all contribute to people's care and support. Staff find the manager to be responsive and helpful and they are able to talk about any ideas or concerns they have. We saw some friendly and supportive banter between staff which shows a rapport has been built throughout the team.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Mae’r adroddiad hwn hefyd ar gael yn Gymraeg

This report is also available in Welsh

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2026.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.